# BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Mon 26 Oct 2026, 23:52 Malaysia time (15:52 UTC)

**BTC ~ $80,272**

CoinGlass, 23:52 MYT | 24h -0.03% | Asia low ~$79,300

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Quick view** | **Bias:** Neutral, slight bearish tilt into Fed | **Next 24h range:** $78,900 - $81,600 | **Key floor:** $79,000 (weekend low / max pain zone) | **Big event:** Fed decision Thu 29 Oct 2:00am MYT; $11-12B expiry Fri 4pm MYT |

## 1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

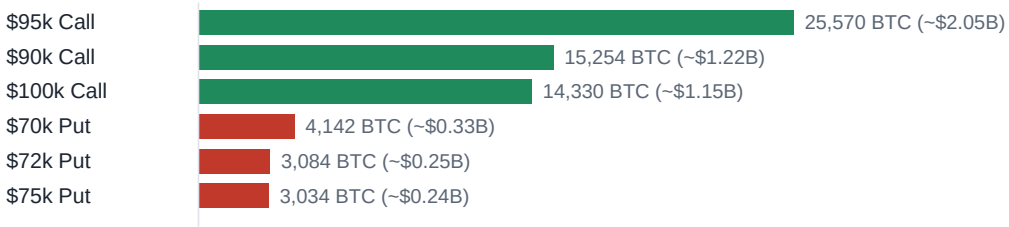
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily, **Tue 27 Oct 4:00pm MYT** (08:00 UTC). Daily expiries are small; strike data for it was not readable this run.
- **How big:** the daily is minor next to Friday's monthly. The most-traded nearby contracts are the **28 Oct $77,000 put** and **28 Oct $84,000 call** - traders are bracketing the Fed decision.
- **Which expiry matters this week: Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm MYT** weekly + monthly, about **$11-12B notional**, roughly 35% of all Deribit BTC options OI.

| Expiry | Largest position seen | Size | Meaning |
|---|---|---|---|
| 28 Oct (Fed day) | $77,000 Put | Most traded (volume) | Main hedge against a hawkish Fed / drop below $79k |
| 28 Oct (Fed day) | $84,000 Call | 2nd most traded | Upside bet that the Fed relief rally reclaims $84k |
| 30 Oct weekly/monthly | $95,000 Call | ~25,570 BTC (~$2.05B) | Far above spot; mostly expires worthless, little pull now |
| 30 Oct weekly/monthly | $70,000 Put | ~4,142 BTC (~$0.33B) | Tail-risk hedge; puts are thin vs calls |

### Upcoming expiries

| Expiry (Malaysia time) | Notional | Put/Call | Max pain | Largest strikes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tue 27 Oct 4:00pm (daily) | Small (n/a) | n/a | n/a | Not readable this run |
| Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm (weekly + monthly) | ~$11-12B | 0.40-0.52 | $78,000-79,000 | Calls $95k, $90k, $100k; Puts $70k, $72k, $75k |
| Fri 27 Nov 4:00pm (monthly) | ~26,779 BTC (~$2.1B, 17 Oct) | n/a | n/a | n/a |
| Fri 25 Dec 4:00pm (quarterly) | Large (n/a) | n/a | n/a | Next major quarterly |

**Fri 30 Oct expiry - largest open interest by strike (BTC, CryptoTicker data as of 17 Oct; USD at $80.3k)**




### How options affect the market now

- **Max pain $78-79k sits just below spot ($80.3k).** Into Friday's 4pm MYT settlement, option sellers profit most if BTC drifts toward $78-79k - a mild downward pull, not a target.
- **The big call walls ($90k-$100k) are far out of the money.** They will likely expire worthless and have little hedging effect at $80k; only a move above $84k would start forcing dealers to buy.
- **Put/Call 0.40-0.52 looks bullish on paper**, but it is mostly stale upside bets from early October when BTC was ~$86k. The fresh flow (most-traded 28 Oct $77k put, put skew ~12.5%) is defensive.

- **Downside acceleration:** put OI is thin, but the $77k/$75k area is where new hedges sit. A break below $79k could pull dealers short-gamma and speed a drop toward $77k.
- **Fed first, expiry second:** the Fed lands ~38 hours before settlement. A surprise either way can move BTC out of the max-pain zone before pinning can work.
- **After Friday:** ~35% of OI rolls off, so expect volatility to loosen and moves to extend more freely into early November (US midterms 3 Nov).

Data note: Deribit API, CoinDesk price and DVOL pages could not be fetched this run. Options figures are 'largest seen' from published articles (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, CryptoBriefing, CoinEdition and FinanceFeeds 26 Oct); strike sizes may have changed since. Implied vol ~32% (FinanceFeeds) implies ~1.7% (~$1,350) daily move.

## 2. Price action and key levels

- BTC is at **~$80,272** (CoinGlass, 23:52 MYT), flat over 24h after an Asia-session dip to **~$79,300** and a high near **$80,800**.
- Two weeks of chop below $85,000; recent attempts above $83,000 failed. The weekend low was ~$79,100 after US Middle East evacuation headlines.
- Momentum is soft: daily RSI ~41, MACD negative (crypto.news). Price is below the ~$81,700 average cost basis of ETF holders - a supply zone for break-even sellers.
- Volume is light (BTC futures volume -7%, OI +0.8%) - traders are waiting for the Fed rather than taking new positions.

| Type | Level | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Resistance 2 | $84,000 - $85,000 | Busiest Fed-day call strike; repeated rejections above $83k; top of 2-week range |
| Resistance 1 | $81,700 - $82,000 | ETF holders' average cost; first recovery level per analysts |
| Pivot | $80,000 | Round number; price has oscillated around it all day |
| Support | $79,000 - $79,300 | Weekend + Asia lows; Oct 30 max pain $78-79k |
| Deep risk | $77,000 then $75,000 | Most-traded Fed-day put; daily close below $79k opens $75k (then $70k put wall) |

## 3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

| Metric | Latest | Read |
|---|---|---|
| BTC futures OI (agg.) | $53.9B (CoinGlass) | Stable; BTC OI +0.8% 24h - no leverage build-up |
| Funding rates | Mildly positive (CoinDesk) | No crowded longs; low squeeze fuel either way |
| Liquidations 24h | ~$153-154M total; longs ~$118M | Longs were flushed on the dip below $80k; BTC share ~$33M |
| Options skew | 1M put skew ~12.5% (from 14.5%) | Puts still richer than calls, fear easing slightly |
| Spot BTC ETFs | 26 Oct: -$169M; 22-23 Oct: -$774M; 7-day ~+$267M to +$301M | Recent days net outflow; weekly still slightly positive |
| Fear & Greed | 51 Neutral (prev 53; 7d avg 56) | Cooling from 67 greed a week ago |
| Implied vol | ~32% (Oct 30 expiry) | Implies ~$1,350/day; Fed could expand this |

## 4. News and macro

- **Fed decides Wed 28 Oct (Thu 2:00am MYT)** after September's 25bp hike to 3.75-4.00%. CME FedWatch ~90% hold, but ~72-80% odds of another hike in December - Chair Warsh's tone is the key risk.
- **US PCE (Sep) and Q3 GDP Thu 29 Oct 8:30pm MYT.** PCE seen ~3.6-3.7% y/y vs 3.4%; GDP ~3.1-3.2%. Hot numbers would reinforce December hike bets.

- **Middle East:** reports Israel is preparing strikes on Iran; Qatari mediators in Tehran; Trump said no strike 'that day' but kept the option open. Brent ~$110-115, WTI ~$101 (both down ~2% today).
- **ETF outflows:** $635.6M on 22 Oct (biggest recent day), $138M on 23 Oct, $169M on 26 Oct - institutional demand is weak near $80k.
- **Positioning shifts:** Arthur Hayes' Maelstrom sold its whole directional book over the weekend; CryptoQuant sees retail inflows to Binance at a 6-month high while whale deposits fall.
- **Security:** a bitcoin wallet bug let rogue servers steal funds during fee-bump payments (CoinDesk, 26 Oct) - wallet-level, not a network issue.

**Event calendar (Malaysia time)**

| When (MYT) | Event |
|---|---|
| Tue 27 Oct 4:00pm | Deribit daily options expiry |
| Tue 27 Oct 8:30pm | US durable goods orders (Sep); FOMC meeting begins |
| Wed 28 Oct 9:45pm | Bank of Canada rate decision |
| Thu 29 Oct 2:00am / 2:30am | **FOMC decision / Warsh press conference** |
| Thu 29 Oct 8:30pm | **US PCE inflation (Sep), Q3 GDP, income & spending** |
| Thu 29 Oct (evening) | ECB rate decision |
| Fri 30 Oct (midday) | Bank of Japan rate decision |
| Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm | **Deribit weekly + monthly BTC expiry (~$11-12B)** |
| Tue 3 Nov | US midterm elections |
| Fri 6 Nov 9:30pm (tentative) | US jobs report (Oct) |
| Fri 27 Nov 4:00pm | Deribit November monthly expiry |
| Thu 10 Dec 3:00am | Next FOMC decision (8-9 Dec) |

## 5. Summary and prediction

BTC is pinned around $80,000 with light volume as markets wait for the Fed. Options add a mild downward gravity: Friday's $11-12B expiry has max pain at $78-79k, just under spot, while the huge $90k-$100k call walls are too far away to help. Fresh option flow is defensive ($77k puts most traded), ETF flows have turned negative, and sentiment has cooled to neutral. Against that, liquidations already flushed longs and funding is not stretched, so a deep crash needs a catalyst (hawkish Fed, Iran strike). Expect a range between $79k and $81.6k until the Fed. **24h call: range-bound $78.9k-$81.6k, slight downside lean; a daily close below $79k is the bear trigger.**

| Scenario | Chance | Range | Trigger |
|---|---|---|---|
| Base: pre-Fed chop | 55% | $78,900 - $81,600 | Quiet US session, no Middle East shock, ETF flows mixed |
| Bullish: relief push | 20% | $81,600 - $84,000 | Reclaim $82k on ETF inflows / softer oil / easing Iran headlines |
| Bearish: support breaks | 25% | $76,500 - $79,000 | Hourly close below $79k, new ETF outflows, strike on Iran or hawkish Fed leaks |

- **Bear signal:** hourly/daily close below $79,000 with rising OI - opens $77k then $75k.
- **Bull signal:** sustained move above $82,000 (ETF cost basis) with positive ETF flow - opens $84k.
- Next report: Tue 27 Oct 7:50am MYT

## Sources

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